

THE DEFINITIVE 10-MONTH PROGRAM

Lean, Athletic, Functional — Built From a Stiff, Sedentary Start

STARTING POINT 100kg, 183cm, male, beginner, weak legs, very stiff / poor mobility	END GOAL Lean and athletic — strong, explosive, good endurance, and mobile. A body that performs, footballer-style.	CORE IDEA Build the right qualities in the right order. For you, mobility isn't a warm-up afterthought — it's a headline act. You'll fix it in parallel with everything else, and it unlocks each stage of training as you go.
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HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

There are five moving parts here: Mobility, Strength, Power, Conditioning, and Nutrition. They run at the same time but change emphasis across four phases. Read the phase map, then each section. The Mobility Program comes first because it's your current limiter and the thing that unlocks everything else.

The whole thing rests on one factor: **consistency over 10 months**. Not intensity, not perfection — showing up, especially in the later months when motivation fades. That single variable decides your result more than any exercise choice below.

THE FIVE QUALITIES

AND WHY ORDER MATTERS

- 1 Mobility** — the range of motion to move and load safely. Yours is the priority. Everything else is limited by it, so it leads.
- 2 Strength** — the foundation power and endurance are built on. Comes early, stays throughout.
- 3 Power / explosiveness** — jumps, sprints, direction changes. Built only after you have strength + mobility, or you get hurt.

- 4 Conditioning** — the aerobic engine (lasts long) and the anaerobic engine (short, intense). Both, layered in over time.
- 5 Body composition** — losing fat, building athletic muscle. Underpins how everything looks and performs.

The beginner mistake is chasing power and hard conditioning on day one with a stiff, untrained body. You'll build in sequence. Slower to start, far further in the end, and you stay healthy.

THE PHASE MAP

PHASE	MONTHS	MOBILITY	TRAINING	CONDITIONING	NUTRITION
1. FOUNDATION	1-3	Restore basic range (priority)	Machines, controlled strength	Easy aerobic + walking	Moderate deficit
2. BUILD	4-6	Loaded range, longer holds	Heavier strength, fuller range	Add intervals	Moderate deficit
3. TRANSITION	7-8	Dynamic + active control	Introduce power / jumps	Sharper intervals, sprint mechanics	Ease toward maintenance
4. PERFORMANCE	9-10	Athletic mobility (control at speed)	Power + speed, strength maintained	Mixed, peak	Maintenance / slight surplus

01 PART 1 THE MOBILITY PROGRAM

This is the part built specifically for "crazy stiff, not flexible at all." Read it carefully — the rules are different when you're starting very tight.

THE RULES FOR A STIFF BODY

WARM, NEVER COLD

Stretch after a walk, a hot shower, or at the end of a workout. Cold-stretching stiff muscle does little and risks tweaks.

EASE TO TENSION, NOT PAIN

Never bounce. Go to the first real point of tension, hold, breathe. Aggression backfires on a stiff body; patience wins.

DAILY BEATS HARD

10 minutes every day beats one brutal weekly session. This is the single most important rule.

SLOW BUT RELIABLE

Real change takes weeks to months. You won't touch your toes next week — but 2–3 months of daily work makes you a different mover. It always comes if you keep showing up.

BREATHE

Long exhales during a hold let the muscle release further. Don't hold your breath.

THE DAILY FOUNDATION ROUTINE

START THIS TODAY – 10 MIN

Do this every day, warm. This is your Phase 1 backbone and stays with you the whole program.

DRILL	TARGET	HOW	TIME
Wall ankle stretch	Ankles	Knee drives toward wall, heel stays down	30s x2/side
Deep supported squat hold	Hips, ankles	Hold a doorframe, sit into a deep squat, relax and breathe	30–60s x2
Half-kneeling hip flexor stretch	Hip flexors	Kneel, tuck pelvis under, push hips forward gently	30s x2/side
Seated/lying hamstring stretch	Hamstrings	Slight knee bend, hinge gently, don't yank	30s x2/side
Glute figure-4 stretch	Glutes/hips	On back, ankle across opposite knee, pull thigh in gently	30s x2/side
90/90 hip stretch	Hip rotation	Both knees bent 90°, one front one side, lean gently	30s/side
Cat-cow	Spine	On all fours, alternate arch and round, slow	8–10 reps
Seated spinal twist	Upper back	Sit tall, rotate gently, hold	20s/side

Tools that are 100% legitimate, not cheating: heels elevated on a small plate when you squat, holding a support for balance, reducing range to what you can control. Use them freely while your body catches up.

HOW MOBILITY PROGRESSES ACROSS THE PHASES

PHASE 1 (MONTHS 1-3) – RESTORE

Just the daily routine above, done religiously, warm. Goal: get basic, pain-free range back. Add a deep supported squat hold you gradually sink lower into. By end of Phase 1, sitting in a deep squat should feel far more natural.

PHASE 2 (MONTHS 4-6) – LOAD THE RANGE

Now you own more range, make it strong through loaded mobility:

- Squats and leg presses through the fullest range you can control – loaded range-of-motion is mobility training.
 - Longer deep squat holds, now trying to relax fully at the bottom.
 - Add Cossack squats (lateral, supported) for hip/adductor range.
 - Begin controlled tempo on lifts – slow lowering builds strength at end range.
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PHASE 3 (MONTHS 7-8) – DYNAMIC + ACTIVE CONTROL

Before you're allowed to jump and sprint, you need to control range actively, not just hold a passive stretch:

- Movement-prep before every session: leg swings (front-back, side-side), walking lunges with a reach, hip circles, world's-greatest-stretch.
 - Active end-range work: e.g. from a deep squat, lift your hands off the floor and hold – teaches strength where you used to be tight.
 - Keep the static daily routine for maintenance.
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PHASE 4 (MONTHS 9-10) – ATHLETIC MOBILITY

Controlling range at speed – the real athletic quality:

- Dynamic warm-ups become fuller and faster.
- Range shows up in your sprints, jumps, and change-of-direction naturally.
- Static routine drops to a maintenance dose (a few days a week) – by now stiffness is largely resolved and you're keeping, not chasing.

HONEST FLAG

If your stiffness is in one specific joint, doesn't ease at all with warmth, or comes with actual pain (not just a tight/restricted feeling) – see a physiotherapist once before ramping up, especially before Phase 3's jumps and sprints. General "stiff everywhere from sitting" almost always resolves with the above; a specific painful joint deserves a proper look.

02 PART 2 THE TRAINING PROGRAM

PHASE 1 – FOUNDATION (MONTHS 1-3)

Job: habit, movement quality, strength base, fat loss. No explosive work – you're building what makes it safe later.

WEEKLY SPLIT

DAY	FOCUS
MON	Legs A (strength)
TUE	Upper + core
WED	Rest / walk / mobility
THU	Legs B (strength)
FRI	Upper + core
SAT	Easy conditioning + mobility
SUN	Rest / walk

LEGS A

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS
Leg press	3	8-12
Goblet or box squat (heels elevated)	3	8-12
Leg extension	3	10-15
Calf raise	4	10-15

LEGS B

EXERCISE	SETS	REPS
Hip thrust / glute bridge	3	8-12
Leg curl (machine)	3	10-15
Supported split squat	2-3	8-10/leg
Leg press (feet high)	3	10-12
Calf raise	4	10-15

Upper body – alternate push and pull: Push: chest press, shoulder press, triceps pushdown, plank. Pull: lat pulldown, seated row, biceps curl, face pull.

Progression: stop 1-2 reps short of failure; hit the top of the rep range on all sets → add a little weight next time. Log everything.

Warm-up (every session): 5 min easy cardio + light ramp-up sets. Never jump straight into your working weight.

PHASE 2 – BUILD (MONTHS 4-6)

Job: mobility's better, base is set – push strength harder, use fuller range, add interval conditioning.

- Deepen squats/split squats as mobility allows; move toward freer squatting.
- Main lifts get heavier; drop top strength moves into 6-10 reps for more strength.
- Same 4 lifting days.

PHASE 3 – ATHLETIC TRANSITION (MONTHS 7-8)

Job: leaner, stronger, moving well – now earn explosive work. Quality over fatigue: power work is done fresh, early, low reps, full rest, always after a thorough warm-up.

ADD TO THE START OF LEG DAYS

MOVEMENT	SETS	REPS	NOTES
Box jumps (step DOWN)	3	3-5	Low box first, land soft
Broad jumps	3	3-5	Stick the landing
Med-ball throws (if available)	3	3-5	Explosive, full-body

Then your normal strength work. Power sits on top of strength – keep lifting.

Sprint mechanics (light): after warm-up, 4-6 × 20-30m accelerations at ~70-80%, full walk-back rest. Build the pattern before going all-out.

PHASE 4 – PERFORMANCE (MONTHS 9-10)

Job: put it together – power, speed, conditioning, strength maintained.

EXAMPLE WEEK

DAY	FOCUS
MON	Lower: power (jumps) + strength
TUE	Upper + core
WED	Conditioning: intervals + sprint work
THU	Lower: strength + single-leg
FRI	Upper + core
SAT	Mixed athletic: agility, sprints, steady aerobic
SUN	Rest / mobility

- **Power/speed:** jumps and bounds (low reps, fresh); sprints progressing faster as mechanics hold; agility/change-of-direction drills (footballer-specific).
- **Strength:** keep 2 lower sessions — you don't drop the lifting; it holds your muscle and underpins everything.

03 PART 3 CONDITIONING (PHASED)

All phases: 8,000–10,000 steps/day. Underrated, joint-friendly, huge for fat loss and recovery.

PHASE 1	one easy 20–30 min aerobic session (bike/incline walk/row), conversational pace. Build the engine gently.
PHASE 2	add a weekly interval session — e.g. 30s harder / 90s easy × 6–8 — plus one steady aerobic session.
PHASE 3	intervals get longer/harder; introduce sprint mechanics; keep one steady session.
PHASE 4	mix of interval work, sprint conditioning, one steady aerobic. You'll notice you recover between efforts far faster than in month 1 — that recovery ability is athleticism.

04 PART 4 NUTRITION (PHASED)

PHASES 1-2 — FAT-LOSS LEAD (MODERATE DEFICIT)

CALORIES 2,300–2,500 per day · maintenance ≈ 2,800–3,000	PROTEIN 160–180g per day — the priority; build every meal around it	CARBS & FATS Keep carbs Fats moderate carbs especially around training — they fuel hard sessions
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Cut first: soda, alcohol, mindless snacks, takeaway frequency.

PHASES 3-4 — PERFORMANCE LEAD (EASE TOWARD MAINTENANCE)

Once you're lean enough to be happy (~month 6–8), grinding a deficit forever saps power and recovery:

- Ease calories up toward maintenance (~2,800–3,000), more carbs around training to fuel power/sprint work.
- Keep protein high (~160–180g).
- Optional slight surplus in the final phase to keep adding athletic muscle — now lean, it shows instead of hiding.

ADJUSTING (ALL PHASES)

Weigh 2–3 mornings/week, use the weekly average.

- **Fat-loss phases:** aim ~0.4–0.6kg/week down. Stalled 2–3 weeks → drop ~200 cal or add walking. Too fast / feeling wrecked → eat more.
- **Performance phases:** hold weight ~steady while performance climbs = you're recomposing.

Judge by weekly average, mirror, waist, how you move, and gym numbers — never one day's scale reading.

SIMPLE DAY — ~2,400 CAL, ~170G PROTEIN

eggs + oats/fruit → chicken or beef + rice + veg → whey shake + fruit → fish or lean meat + potatoes + big veg

Template, not a prison — swap like-for-like.

05 PART 5 RECOVERY (WHERE YOU ACTUALLY ADAPT)

SLEEP 7-9 HOURS

Highest-leverage free thing you can do. Strength, power, fat loss and mobility all worsen without it.

RESPECT REST DAYS

Muscle and nervous system rebuild off the gym floor, especially once power work starts.

WARM UP EVERY SESSION

5 min easy cardio + light ramp-ups; power/sprint work needs a thorough warm-up.

PAIN RULES

Effort and muscle burn = good; sharp joint pain = stop. Persistent joint pain (not stiffness) → one or two physio visits, especially before jumps/sprints.

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PART 6

TRACKING PROGRESS

Keep a simple weekly log. Watch the trends, not any single day:

STRENGTH — main lifts trending up?	BODYWEIGHT — weekly average moving right for the phase?
WAIST — the honest fat gauge.	CONDITIONING — more work / faster recovery than last month?
MOBILITY — squatting deeper, moving freer than before?	POWER (PHASE 3+) — jumps further, sprints smoother?

Trending right = winning, regardless of a bad day.

REALISTIC 10-MONTH OUTCOME

BODYWEIGHT	~low-to-mid 80s kg (down 15–20kg), lean and defined
MOBILITY	transformed — most of the current stiffness gone; deep squats, free movement
LEGS	strong, developed, mobile — no longer the weak point
STRENGTH	~2–3× your starting lower-body numbers
POWER	you can jump, accelerate, change direction like an athlete
ENDURANCE	both engines built — you last, and recover fast
OVERALL	lean, athletic, functional — a body that performs, footballer-style

THE PART THAT DECIDES IT

Not the program. Not a perfect meal. Consistency across 10 months – and specifically, still showing up in months 7, 8, 9, 10, exactly when most people have quietly drifted off. The guys who get this result aren't more gifted. They just didn't stop.

FIX THE RANGE. BUILD THE BASE. EARN THE POWER. FUEL THE WORK. SLEEP. SHOW UP.

Start the mobility routine today. Start Phase 1 training on Monday.